

Instructor Booking Workflow

This guide outlines the end-to-end flow for live session bookings so that support, instructors, and students share the same expectations.

1. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Key responsibilities	Primary screens
Student	Request, reschedule, cancel sessions; prepare after approval	Dashboard → Student → My Bookings, Messages
Instructor	Review requests, negotiate timing, approve/decline/cancel, mark sessions complete	Dashboard → Instructor → Bookings, Messages, Availability
Admin	Monitor volume/status, investigate edge cases (no direct intervention required)	Dashboard → Admin → Bookings

2. Status Lifecycle

pending → approved → completed
└─ declined
└─ cancelled

- **pending** – student has submitted (or resubmitted) a time slot; instructor decision is required.
- **approved** – instructor confirmed the time; both parties prepare for the session.
- **completed** – instructor has delivered the session and marked it done.
- **declined** – instructor declined the request (optional reason captured in notes).
- **cancelled** – student or instructor cancelled after a request was made.

All status transitions are persisted in `bookings.status` and reflected immediately on student, instructor, and admin dashboards.

3. Detailed Flow

1. Student requests a booking

- Path: Instructor profile → “Request Booking”.
- Required inputs: desired start time, duration (defaults to 60 minutes), session notes.
- System stores request as `pending` ; student sees it under **Pending** in `My Bookings` .

2. Negotiation (optional)

- Channel: in-app `Messages` .
- Student can reschedule from `My Bookings` → “Reschedule”, which updates start/end times and resets status to `pending` .
- Instructor can reply via messages or leave decision notes when approving/declining.

3. Instructor decision

- Path: `Dashboard → Instructor → Bookings` .
- Actions:
 - **Approve Booking** → status becomes `approved` .
 - **Decline Request** → status becomes `declined` ; optional note shared with the student.

- **Cancel Booking** → status becomes `cancelled` (available for both `pending` and `approved` sessions).

4. Preparation window

- Once approved, student and instructor coordinate logistics (e.g., meeting link) via Messages or external tools.
- Student may still reschedule or cancel before the start time if necessary.

5. Session delivery

- Session occurs off-platform (Zoom, Meet, etc.).

6. Completion

- Instructor reopens the booking modal and clicks **Mark as Completed**.
- Status becomes `completed` and moves into “Completed” metrics across dashboards.

7. Post-session follow-up (optional)

- Future enhancements can plug in surveys, payments, or automated reminders; the status flow already supports them.

4. UI Touchpoints by Role

Student

- `Dashboard → Student → My Bookings`
 - Tabs for `All`, `Pending`, `Approved`, `Completed`, `Cancelled`, `Declined`.
 - Actions: Reschedule (while pending/approved), Cancel, Delete (for cancelled/declined/completed records).
- `Messages`
 - Direct messaging with instructor for clarification or negotiation.

Instructor

- `Dashboard → Instructor → Availability`
 - Publish/revise availability slots that appear in the student booking modal.
- `Dashboard → Instructor → Bookings`
 - Filter/search cards + detail modal with actions (Approve, Decline, Cancel, Mark as Completed).
- `Messages`
 - Central channel for conversation and sharing meeting links.

Admin

- `Dashboard → Admin → Bookings`
 - Read-only overview with filters, stats, and the same detail modal (without state-changing actions).

5. Notifications & Messaging

Current behaviour: toasts are shown in-app for the actor performing an action; email/SMS notifications are not yet wired. If you introduce notifications later, trigger them on the API endpoints that update booking status (`PATCH /bookings/instructor/:id` , `PATCH /bookings/student/:id`).

Recommended touchpoints:

- Student receives a message/toast when instructor approves, declines, cancels.
- Instructor receives a message/toast when student reschedules or cancels.

- Admin may receive digest reports (future enhancement).

6. Data Points Captured

Field	Description
start_time, end_time	ISO timestamps (UTC) for the session window.
notes	Student-supplied notes; instructors may append notes when changing status.
status	Booking lifecycle value described above.
student_id, instructor_id	Link to users table for avatar/name display.
requested_at	When the booking was first created (ordered descending in listings).

7. Support Playbook

- 1. Student asks “why is my booking still pending?”**
 - Confirm instructor has seen it; remind them to approve or message the student for a new time.
- 2. Instructor wants to change the time after approval**
 - Ask the student to reschedule; the request will go back to pending, allowing re-approval.
- 3. Session finished but still shows approved**
 - Instruct the instructor to open the booking modal and tap “Mark as Completed”.
- 4. Cancelled by mistake**
 - Create a new booking; cancellations are soft-deleted from metrics but retained for auditing.
- 5. Need evidence for a dispute**
 - Cross-check `bookings` table (notes, timestamps) and conversation history in `messages` .

8. Future Considerations

- Automated reminders (email/SMS) before session start.
- Payment capture or invoicing tied to status transitions.
- Student feedback form triggered after completion.
- Calendar export or ICS attachments once approved.

Keep this guide updated as the product evolves so the booking department always has the latest process.